

GraphQL

If gRPC is the REST killer inside the cluster, then GraphQL is the REST killer at the edge. GraphQL is simply a superior paradigm. It gives the frontend developers a lot of freedom to evolve their designs. It decouples the needs of the frontend from the rigid APIs of the backend and serves as the perfect BFF (backends-for-frontends) pattern. See <https://samnewman.io/patterns/architectural/bff/>.

Similar to gRPC contracts, the structured schema of a GraphQL service is very enticing for large-scale systems.

In addition, GraphQL solves the dreaded $N+1$ problems of traditional REST APIs, where you first fetch a list of N resources from a REST endpoint and then you have to make N more calls (one per resource) to get related resources on each of the N items in the list.

I expect GraphQL to gain more and more mindshare as developers become more comfortable, awareness grows, tooling improves, and learning materials become more available.

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